DocFlow AI - Complete Workflow Guide

End-to-end workflow from organization setup to approval, document processing, reminders, reports, and certificates.

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Complete Business Workflow

This document explains the full end-to-end operational flow from organization setup to request approval and reporting.

High-level flow

1. Super Admin creates/activates organization and platform users.
2. Organization Admin creates departments and users.
3. Organization Admin creates workflows and policies.
4. User creates approval request as Draft.
5. User uploads documents.
6. System extracts PDF text or runs OCR fallback.
7. AI service generates summary, category, risk, and extracted fields.
8. User submits request.
9. System generates approval steps.
10. Approvers approve/reject/comment.
11. System sends notifications/reminders.
12. Reports and PDFs can be generated.

Request Status Lifecycle

Status	Meaning	Allowed Actions
DRAFT	Request created but not submitted.	Edit, upload, replace, delete, submit.
SUBMITTED	Submitted and preparing workflow.	Usually transitions to In Review.
IN_REVIEW	Approval workflow active.	Approvers act on current step.
APPROVED	All required approval steps approved.	View, report, certificate.
REJECTED	Current approver rejected.	View timeline and reason.
CANCELLED	Creator cancelled before completion.	View only.

Approval Step Lifecycle

Each submitted request has generated approval steps. Only one step is current at a time in sequential workflows.

1. Step starts as Pending.
2. First step gets is_current=True.
3. Approver reviews details and attachments.
4. Approver may comment.
5. Approver approves or rejects.
6. On approval, next pending step becomes current.
7. On final approval, request becomes Approved.
8. On rejection, request becomes Rejected.

SLA and reminders

• Each workflow step can have SLA hours.

• Due date is calculated when step is generated.

• Overdue detection can mark step as overdue.

• Manual reminder button can notify approver.

• Celery scheduled tasks can send daily summaries and escalation reminders.

Document Handling Workflow

1. Upload document while request is Draft.

2. System saves metadata: filename, type, size, uploader, timestamps.

3. For text PDF, system extracts text directly.

4. For scanned PDF/image, OCR fallback extracts text and confidence.

5. If low confidence, user/admin can manually correct text.

6. AI service processes extracted text.

7. Replacement creates version snapshot.

8. Rollback restores old version while saving current file as a new version.

Versioning workflow

• Current file is active attachment.

• When replaced, old current file becomes a DocumentAttachmentVersion.

• Version comparison shows old vs current metadata/text.

• Rollback is allowed only while Draft.

Reporting Workflow

Reports module provides approval request reports, department-wise reports, risk-level reports, CSV/PDF export, printable summary pages, and approval certificate PDFs.

• Request summary PDF for a single approval request.

• Approval certificate PDF after approval.

• Printable approval summary page.

• CSV export for analysis.

• Department/risk filters for admin/auditor review.

• QR verification link for request authenticity if configured.